

# Idioms with "Hand"



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## 👋 Idioms with "Hand"

A collection of common English idioms using the word *hand*, each with a clear definition and an easy example.

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### 1. Handful

**Meaning:** A small number or amount

**Example:** Only a handful of people came to the meeting.

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### 2. Hand something to someone

**Meaning:** To give something directly

**Example:** She handed the phone to her boss.

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### 3. On hand

**Meaning:** Available or present

**Example:** We always keep extra snacks on hand for visitors.

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### 4. An old hand

**Meaning:** An expert or very experienced person

**Example:** He's an old hand at fixing cars.

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## **5. Second hand**

**Meaning:** Not new; used

**Example:** I bought a second-hand bicycle to save money.

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## **6. Underhanded**

**Meaning:** Dishonest or sneaky

**Example:** That was an underhanded way to win the game.

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## **7. Change hands**

**Meaning:** To be sold or passed to a new owner

**Example:** The shop has changed hands several times.

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## **8. Hand down**

**Meaning:** To pass something from one generation to the next

**Example:** My grandmother handed down this ring to me.

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## **9. First hand**

**Meaning:** Directly, without a middle person

**Example:** I heard the story first hand from the witness.

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## **10. Give someone a free hand / Have a free hand**

**Meaning:** To allow someone to do whatever they choose

**Example:** The manager gave me a free hand to redesign the office.

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## **11. Have a hand in something**

**Meaning:** To help or be involved

**Example:** She had a hand in organizing the event.

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## **12. Hand it to someone**

**Meaning:** To give credit or praise

**Example:** You've got to hand it to him—he really worked hard.

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### **13. Give someone a big hand / Get a big hand**

**Meaning:** To applaud someone loudly

**Example:** Let's give the speaker a big hand!

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### **14. Handy**

**Meaning:** Convenient or useful

**Example:** This pocketknife is really handy for camping.

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### **15. Have one's hands full**

**Meaning:** To be very busy

**Example:** I've got my hands full with work and kids right now.

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### **16. Hand in**

**Meaning:** To give something (like a document) to someone in authority

**Example:** Please hand in your homework by Friday.

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### **17. Hand out**

**Meaning:** To distribute

**Example:** They handed out flyers at the event.

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### **18. On the one hand / On the other hand**

**Meaning:** Two different or opposing points of view

**Example:** On the one hand, I want a new job. On the other hand, I like my coworkers.

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